DBMON-99: Best Practice Summary

> **Series:** DBMON — Database Monitoring | **Notebook:** 7 of 7 | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 10/23/2026

Overview

This notebook consolidates every actionable best practice for Dynatrace database monitoring extracted from the DBMON series (notebooks 01 through 06). It covers SQL databases, NoSQL databases, caches, message brokers, query analysis, dashboards, and alerting. Each best practice is definitive: it specifies exactly what to configure, what threshold to set, and what priority to assign.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	Dynatrace SaaS with Grail (Managed has no Grail, so these DQL cells do not run there)
OneAgent	Deployed on all application hosts making database, cache, and messaging calls
ActiveGate	Environment ActiveGate for Extensions 2.0 (remote DB metrics), or — SQL extensions only, Dynatrace 1.346+ (staged rollout; verify it has reached your tenant) — SQL Extension Executor on Kubernetes via Dynatrace Operator 1.8+
Permissions	`storage:spans:read`, `storage:entities:read`, `storage:metrics:read`
Prior Reading	DBMON-01 through DBMON-06 for full context

1. OneAgent Instrumentation

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
1	Deploy OneAgent on every host that makes database calls	OneAgent installed on all application servers, not just database servers	**Critical**	Deployment
2	Enable deep code-level instrumentation	OneAgent auto-instruments JDBC, ADO.NET, and native database drivers by default; do not disable	**Critical**	Deployment
3	Verify `db.system` attribute is populated	Run `fetch spans, from:-1h | filter isNotNull(db.system) | summarize count(), by:{db.system}` — every expected technology must appear	**Critical**	Validation
4	Verify `db.query.text` capture	Confirm statements appear in `db.query.text` (parameterized SQL keeps its placeholders; `WHERE`-clause literals are masked). It is not on every DB span — 58% of SQL Server and 0% of Redis spans on the validation tenant — so check coverage before grouping on it	**Critical**	Validation
5	Confirm `db.namespace` is present	Run `filter isNotNull(db.namespace)` on spans; missing values indicate driver-level gaps	**Recommended**	Validation

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
6	Ensure `server.address` and `server.port` resolve	These fields must contain the actual database endpoint, not `localhost` or `127.0.0.1` when the DB is remote	**Recommended**	Validation

2. ActiveGate Extensions

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
7	Build new database integrations on Extensions 2.0	Extensions 2.0 is the current extensions framework; Extensions Framework 1.0 reached end of support on 2025-03-31 (Python EF1.0: 2024-10-31). JMX and PMI EF1.0 extensions were the exception, supported past March 2025 as deprecated; they now have their own end-of-support date of **July 1, 2027** for SaaS environments. The SQL / Prometheus / SNMP data sources these extensions use run on an **Environment (host-based) ActiveGate**, the working path; SQL extensions (Oracle, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL/MariaDB, SAP HANA, Db2, Generic JDBC) can alternatively run on **SQL Extension Executor pods in Kubernetes** via Dynatrace Operator 1.8+, from Dynatrace 1.346 — a staged rollout, so verify it has reached your tenant; until then the Environment ActiveGate remains the working path	**Critical**	Deployment

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
7b	Extensions are YAML-defined with optional Python data sources	YAML package executed by EEC; built-in SQL/Prometheus/SNMP data sources cover most cases; Python data source is for custom logic only — not required by default	**Recommended**	Architecture
7c	Route extension logs to the `default_database_monitoring` bucket	Default destination for extension log output; reference this bucket name in IAM policies for DB-team access scoping (see ORGNZ-02 + IAM-04/05)	**Recommended**	IAM/Bucket
8	Install PostgreSQL extension	Captures: connections, transactions/sec, tuple operations, table/index sizes, lock waits, replication lag	**Recommended**	Extension
9	Install MySQL extension	Captures: connections, queries/sec, buffer pool hit ratio, InnoDB row ops, slow queries	**Recommended**	Extension
10	Install MS SQL Server extension	Captures: batch requests/sec, page life expectancy, buffer cache hit ratio, deadlocks, wait stats	**Recommended**	Extension
11	Install Oracle extension	Captures: sessions, tablespace usage, SGA/PGA memory, redo log waits, library cache hit ratio	**Recommended**	Extension
12	Install MongoDB extension	Captures: connections, operations/sec, document metrics, replica set health, storage engine stats	**Recommended**	Extension
13	Set extension polling interval to 60 seconds	Default polling; do not exceed 300s or real-time visibility degrades	**Recommended**	Configuration

Dynatrace Databases App

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
13b	Use the Databases app for first-pass triage	The docs list vendors *"such as PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, Oracle, MariaDB, and HanaDB"*, and *"Health highlights instances with critical, warning, or no active alerts"* — check it before running manual DQL analysis (per instance, the docs also define a weighted 0–100 health score)	**Recommended**	Triage
13c	Use the app's execution-plan visualization as a first pass, not a replacement	Normalizes execution plans across PostgreSQL, MySQL, and SQL Server; fall back to the ActiveGate extension metrics above (rows 8-11) and the DQL patterns in DBMON-02/05 for deep-dive analysis the app's UI doesn't cover	**Recommended**	Diagnostics

> **Sources:** Extensions (DT docs) — the Extensions 2.0 framework and the EEC execution model, Extension data sources (DT docs) — the built-in SQL / Prometheus / SNMP data sources and the optional Python data source, Run SQL extensions on Kubernetes (DT docs), Enable Dynatrace SQL database extensions (DT docs), What's new in Dynatrace SaaS 1.337 (DT docs) — the `default_database_monitoring` bucket, End-of-support announcements (DT docs) — lists *"Dynatrace Extension Framework 1.0"* under the 2025-03-31 end-of-support date and *"Dynatrace Extension Framework 1.0 (Python 3.8)"* under 2024-10-31, with the note *"Note that JMX and PMI Extensions Framework 1.0 are supported past March 2025 but are deprecated"*, re-read 09/28/2026, EF1 JMX and PMI extensions end of support (DT docs) — *"As of July 1, 2027, all Extension Framework 1.0 JMX and PMI extensions will be out of support for SaaS Environments"*, Database health score overview (DT docs) — *"The health score is the weighted average of all checks."*

3. Span Attribute Coverage

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
14	Validate all six core DB span attributes	Every database span must carry: `db.system`, `db.query.text`, `db.operation.name`, `db.namespace`, `server.address`, `server.port`	**Critical**	Data Quality

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
15	Check for NULL fields periodically	Run `filter isNotNull(db.operation.name)` — NULL can mean the instrumentation carries the command in another field (`code.function` for OneAgent MongoDB, `span.name` for OTel Redis) rather than a driver fault; check those before investigating the driver version	**Recommended**	Data Quality
16	Verify span.kind is client for outgoing DB calls	All database spans from the calling application must have `span.kind == "client"` (lowercase)	**Recommended**	Data Quality
17	For Kafka, verify `messaging.system` attribute	Kafka spans use `messaging.system` (not `db.system`); confirm `messaging.destination.name` , `messaging.operation.type` , and `messaging.consumer.group.name` are populated	**Critical**	Data Quality
18	For RabbitMQ, verify `messaging.system` attribute	RabbitMQ spans use `messaging.system` (not `db.system`); confirm `messaging.destination.name` is populated	**Critical**	Data Quality

4. SQL Database Monitoring

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
19	Set slow query threshold for SQL databases	**500ms** — any SQL query exceeding `duration > 500ms` is classified as slow	**Critical**	Threshold
20	Track read/write ratio	Classify SQL from the statement text, not `db.operation.name` : batched writes are named after their first keyword (`SET`), `PREPARE` / `RESULTSET` repeat a statement's text, and `CONNECT` / `COMMIT` are not statements	**Recommended**	Analysis
21	Rank queries by total execution time, not average	Sort by `total_time_ms = sum(duration)` to find highest-impact patterns regardless of individual speed	**Critical**	Optimization

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
22	Monitor response time distribution using latency tiers	Bucket into: `<1ms`, `1-10ms`, `10-100ms`, `100ms-1s`, `>1s` — track tier distribution over time	**Recommended**	Analysis
23	Baseline P50, P95, P99 over 24 hours	Run hourly percentile query on `duration` for each `db.system`; this is your performance reference point	**Critical**	Baseline
24	Monitor vendor-specific patterns	PostgreSQL: vacuum/lock contention; MySQL: buffer pool/replication lag; MSSQL: page life expectancy/deadlocks; Oracle: tablespace/SGA	**Recommended**	Vendor
25	Track errors by the recorded exception	Group `span.status_code == "error"` spans by the exception recorded in `span.events` (`exception.type`, `exception.message`) to distinguish connection timeouts, pool exhaustion, deadlocks, and constraint violations; `span.status_message` is experimental and often empty	**Critical**	Error Handling

Sprint-1.338 Update (May 2026)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
25b	Use DQL `timeseries` for table/index metrics — classic ingest is blocked	Classic ingest is blocked for `postgres.tables.*`, `postgres.indexes.*`, `mysql.tables.*` and `mysql.indexes.*` (SaaS 1.338) — *"Ingested metrics with these keys are only available in Grail."* Query them with DQL `timeseries`.	**Critical**	API/Migration

> **Sources:** What's new in Dynatrace SaaS 1.338 (DT docs) — *"To prevent dimension cardinality explosion for the latest versions of the database extensions"*, and *"Ingested metrics with these keys are only available in Grail."*

In community practice these thresholds are the values teams converge on as starting points — Dynatrace publishes none of them. Treat each as a first guess to tune against your own baseline, not a recommended setting.

5. NoSQL Database Monitoring

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
26	Set slow query threshold for NoSQL databases	**100ms** for MongoDB; **300ms** critical threshold for all NoSQL	**Critical**	Threshold
27	Monitor MongoDB by collection	Group by `db.collection.name` in addition to `db.namespace` — collection-level granularity reveals hot spots	**Critical**	MongoDB
28	Track DynamoDB Scan-to-Query ratio	`Scan` operations read every item in the table; ratio must be Query-dominated; any high Scan count signals missing Global Secondary Indexes	**Critical**	DynamoDB
29	Set Cassandra slow threshold at 200ms	`filter duration > 200ms` — Cassandra operations exceeding 200ms indicate partition hotspots or cross-DC reads	**Recommended**	Cassandra
30	Monitor Cosmos DB by operation and error rate	Track `ReadItem`, `CreateItem`, `Query`, `ReplaceItem` separately; errors indicate RU throttling (HTTP 429)	**Recommended**	Cosmos DB
31	Classify NoSQL read/write operations correctly	Use `coalesce(db.operation.name, code.function)` (OneAgent MongoDB leaves `db.operation.name` empty); READ: `find`, `count`, `aggregate`, `getMore`, `Query`, `Scan`, `GetItem`, `SELECT`, `ReadItem`, `get`, `search`; WRITE: an explicit insert/update/delete/put list; anything else OTHER	**Recommended**	Analysis
32	Run cross-database comparison	Compare `total_calls`, `avg_ms`, `p95_ms`, `error_rate_pct` across all NoSQL systems in a single query for unified health view	**Recommended**	Analysis

6. Cache Monitoring (Redis / Memcached)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
33	Set Redis slow command threshold at 5ms	`filter duration > 5ms` — Redis operations should complete in microseconds; anything over 5ms is abnormal	**Critical**	Threshold
34	Monitor Redis read/write balance	READ: `GET`, `MGET`, `HGET`, `HGETALL`, `LRANGE`, `SMEMBERS`, `ZRANGE`; WRITE: `SET`, `MSET`, `HSET`, `HMSET`, `LPUSH`, `RPUSH`, `SADD`, `ZADD`, `DEL`, `EXPIRE`; read the command from `coalesce(db.operation.name, span.name)`	**Recommended**	Analysis
35	Alert on Redis latency spikes	Track `p95_us` (microseconds) over time at 5m intervals; any sustained increase above 5000us (5ms) triggers investigation	**Critical**	Alerting
36	Watch for expensive Redis commands	`KEYS *`, `SMEMBERS` on large sets, `LRANGE` with large ranges cause latency spikes — flag any occurrence	**Critical**	Anti-Pattern
37	Report cache metrics in microseconds, not milliseconds	Redis and Memcached latency is sub-millisecond; use `avg(duration) / 1us` for microsecond precision (dividing a duration by a plain number leaves it a duration)	**Recommended**	Reporting

.NET Redis Client Coverage — OneAgent 1.337 and 1.343

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
37b	Confirm StackExchange.Redis instrumentation on .NET workloads	OneAgent 1.337 added StackExchange.Redis coverage for .NET applications. Verify your .NET services produce `db.system == "redis"` spans.	**Recommended**	Coverage

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
37c	Confirm ServiceStack.Redis instrumentation on .NET workloads	Forthcoming / rolling out with **OneAgent 1.343** (released 07/28/2026): tracing support added for **ServiceStack.Redis** in .NET applications. Rollout is **per agent fleet, not per tenant** — **verify the OneAgent version installed on the hosts concerned** (the tenant version is not the agent version), then confirm those services produce `db.system == "redis"` spans. On **OneAgent 1.342 and earlier** only StackExchange.Redis is auto-instrumented, and ServiceStack.Redis calls produce no database spans	**Recommended**	Coverage

In community practice these thresholds are the values teams converge on as starting points — Dynatrace publishes none of them. Treat each as a first guess to tune against your own baseline, not a recommended setting.

7. Message Broker Monitoring (Kafka / RabbitMQ)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
38	Track Kafka throughput by topic	Group by `messaging.destination.name` and `messaging.operation.type` (Dynatrace's dictionary: `publish`, `receive`, `process`, `peek`; newer OpenTelemetry producers send `send`) at 5m intervals	**Critical**	Kafka
39	Monitor Kafka consumer group processing latency	Group by `messaging.consumer.group.name` and `messaging.destination.name`; track `avg_ms` and `p95_ms` per group	**Critical**	Kafka
40	Detect Kafka consumer errors	Filter `span.status_code == "error"` on `messaging.operation.type == "process"` spans; any sustained errors indicate poisoned messages or deserialization failures	**Critical**	Kafka
41	Track RabbitMQ publish/consume rate per queue	Group by `messaging.destination.name` and `messaging.operation.type`; a publish rate exceeding consume rate signals backpressure	**Critical**	RabbitMQ
42	Monitor RabbitMQ message throughput trend	Use `makeTimeseries` at 5m intervals grouped by `messaging.operation.type` to detect throughput drops	**Recommended**	RabbitMQ

8. Search Engine Monitoring (Elasticsearch)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
43	Set Elasticsearch slow query threshold at 200ms	`filter duration > 200ms` for search operations; indexing operations use a separate threshold	**Recommended**	Threshold
44	Break down Elasticsearch operations by type	Track `db.operation.name` (search, index, bulk, delete) separately; search latency and indexing throughput have different SLOs	**Recommended**	Analysis
45	Include OpenSearch in all Elasticsearch queries	Always filter `in(db.system, {"elasticsearch", "opensearch"})` — treat both identically	**Recommended**	Compatibility

9. Query Analysis and Optimization

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
46	Detect N+1 queries	Group spans by `trace.id` and `db.query.text`; any pattern with `calls_per_trace >= 10` is an N+1 candidate; >= 50 is confirmed N+1	**Critical**	Anti-Pattern
47	Fix N+1 by batching	Replace N individual queries with a single batch query using `IN` clauses or JOINs	**Critical**	Remediation
48	Detect missing indexes heuristically	SELECT queries with `call_count >= 50` AND `avg_ms > 10` AND high `stddev_ms / avg_ms` ratio are index candidates	**Recommended**	Optimization
49	Detect queries getting slower over time	Run 24h `makeTimeseries` of `avg(duration)` by `db.system` at 1h intervals; rising trend signals index degradation or table growth	**Recommended**	Trend
50	Flag dynamic SQL / poor parameterization	Count one-off query patterns (`call_count == 1`); high count per `db.system` means queries are not parameterized, preventing plan caching	**Recommended**	Anti-Pattern
51	Prioritize optimization by total time impact	Sort query patterns by `total_time_ms = sum(duration)` , not by `avg_ms` — a fast query called 1M times has more impact than a slow query called once	**Critical**	Optimization

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
52	Use the tail ratio to detect outliers	Calculate `p99_ms / p50_ms`; a ratio above 10 indicates severe tail latency requiring investigation	**Recommended**	Analysis
53	Monitor connection pool pressure	Track `countIf(span.status_code == "error")` grouped by `dt.service.name` and `server.address`; connection refused or timeout errors indicate pool exhaustion	**Critical**	Connection Pool
54	Track error rate trend over 6h at 5m intervals	Use `makeTimeseries` with `total` and `errors` counts; a rising error trend within 30 minutes demands immediate action	**Critical**	Error Handling

10. Dashboards and KPIs

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
55	Build a unified health overview tile	Single query: group by `db.system`, show `total_calls`, `avg_ms`, `p95_ms`, `error_rate_pct`, `slow_rate_pct`	**Critical**	Dashboard
56	Include a "total database calls" single-value tile	`fetch spans, from:-1h | filter isNotNull(db.system) | summarize total_db_calls = count()`	**Critical**	Dashboard
57	Add "top 10 heaviest services" table tile	Group by `dt.service.name` with `call_count`, `avg_ms`, `error_count` (`dt.entity.service` is deprecated in the semantic dictionary)	**Critical**	Dashboard
58	Show P50 vs P95 vs P99 trend chart	6h timeseries at 5m intervals; three lines on one chart reveals tail latency divergence	**Critical**	Dashboard
59	Add read vs write ratio trend tile	Classify operations into READ / WRITE / OTHER (rule 20); 6h timeseries at 5m intervals	**Recommended**	Dashboard
60	Add queries-per-minute trend by db.system	6h timeseries at 1m intervals; used for throughput anomaly detection	**Recommended**	Dashboard
61	Add today-vs-yesterday volume comparison	Use `append` pattern: `from:-24h` for today, `from:-48h, to:-24h` for yesterday	**Recommended**	Dashboard
62	Include slow query detail table	Last 15m, `duration > 500ms`, fields: start_time, db.system, db.namespace, db.query.text, duration_ms, service_name	**Critical**	Dashboard

11. Alerting Thresholds

Error Rate Alerts

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
63	Alert on error rate > 5% for 5 minutes	Severity: **Critical** — immediate page	**Critical**	Alert
64	Alert on error rate > 1% for 15 minutes	Severity: **Warning** — notification	**Critical**	Alert
65	Alert on any connection refused error	Severity: **Critical** — immediate page; zero tolerance for connection failures	**Critical**	Alert
66	Alert on deadlocks from the engine side	Severity: **Warning** — notification; use the Databases app's lock and wait metrics, since spans see a deadlock only as the victim session's error (DBMON-06)	**Recommended**	Alert

Slow Query Alerts (P95 Thresholds)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
67	SQL Warning threshold	P95 > **200ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
68	SQL Critical threshold	P95 > **500ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
69	NoSQL Warning threshold	P95 > **100ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
70	NoSQL Critical threshold	P95 > **300ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
71	Cache (Redis/Memcached) Warning threshold	P95 > **5ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
72	Cache (Redis/Memcached) Critical threshold	P95 > **20ms** over 5-minute window	**Critical**	Alert
73	Elasticsearch Warning threshold	P95 > **500ms** over 5-minute window	**Recommended**	Alert
74	Elasticsearch Critical threshold	P95 > **2000ms** over 5-minute window	**Recommended**	Alert

Throughput Alerts

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
75	Alert on throughput drop > 50% vs 7-day average	Compare current queries/min to 7-day baseline; sudden drop indicates upstream failure or connectivity loss	**Critical**	Alert
76	Alert on slow query count > 10 per 5-minute window	Sustained slow query volume indicates systemic degradation, not a one-off outlier	**Recommended**	Alert

12. SLO Definitions

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
77	Define availability SLO	**99.9%** of database calls succeed, measured over a 24h rolling window as `count() - countIf(span.status_code == "error")` — `span.status_code` is null on successful spans, so a `!= "error"` comparison counts nothing	**Critical**	SLO
78	Define latency SLO	**95%** of calls complete under the vendor-specific P95 threshold (SQL: 500ms, NoSQL: 300ms, Cache: 20ms, Search: 2000ms)	**Critical**	SLO
79	Define throughput SLO	No more than **50% drop** from 7-day baseline queries/min	**Recommended**	SLO
80	Measure SLO compliance hourly	Run `makeTimeseries` at 1h intervals with `total` and `errors` / `under_threshold` counts per `db.system`	**Critical**	SLO
81	Track SLO budget burn rate	If 24h availability drops below 99.9%, calculate remaining error budget: `(1 - 0.999) * total_calls - error_count`	**Recommended**	SLO

13. DQL Query Standards

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
82	Always specify a time range on fetch	`fetch spans, from:-1h` — never omit `from:` on span queries; default 2h scan is excessive	**Critical**	DQL

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
83	Filter on `isNotNull(db.system)` first	This is the primary filter to isolate database spans; apply immediately after `fetch`	**Critical**	DQL
84	Use named parameters in functions	`round(value, decimals: 2)`, `if(cond, then: "x", else: "y")` — positional parameters cause errors	**Critical**	DQL
85	Alias all aggregations	`summarize c = count()`, not `summarize count()` — unaliased aggregations get a generated name (`count()`) that must be backtick-quoted to reference; `sort count() desc` without backticks fails	**Critical**	DQL
86	Use duration arithmetic (NOT nanosecond constants)	Write `duration / 1ms`, `duration / 1s`, `(t2-t1) / 1m` — divide a duration by another duration to get a unitless number. Never `duration / 1000000.0`; never `toLong(duration) / 1ms` (long/duration fails type-check). Per `dt-dql-essentials`.	**Critical**	DQL
87	Show service names, not IDs	On spans, group by `dt.service.name` (stable). Where you hold a Smartscape ID, `getNodeName(dt.smartscape.service)` resolves it; `entityName(dt.entity.service, …)` is the classic form and `dt.entity.service` is deprecated. Never show raw entity IDs in dashboards.	**Recommended**	DQL
88	Filter early, sort last	Apply `filter` immediately after `fetch`; apply `sort` only after `summarize`; never `sort` right after `fetch`	**Critical**	DQL
89	Use `countIf()` for conditional aggregation	`errors = countIf(span.status_code == "error")` inside `summarize` — do not use separate filter + count	**Recommended**	DQL
90	Calculate error rate with safe division	`error_rate_pct = round((toDouble(error_count) / toDouble(total_calls)) * 100, decimals: 2)` — use `toDouble()` to avoid integer truncation	**Recommended**	DQL

Modern DQL standards (added 2026-05-07)

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Category
91	Use `event.status` / `event.start` / `event.end` on `dt.davis.problems`	NOT `status` / `end_time` (recurring authoring bug). Status values are `"ACTIVE"` and `"CLOSED"` (not `"OPEN"`). For duration: `(event.end - event.start) / 1m` (NOT `event.end - timestamp` — `timestamp` is record-write time, not problem-open time).	**Critical**	DQL
92	Prefer `smartscapeNodes "<TYPE>"` for new entity queries	Modern Smartscape topology query: `smartscapeNodes "SERVICE"`, `smartscapeNodes "HOST"`, etc. Legacy `fetch dt.entity.<type>` still works on hybrid tenants but is deprecated.	**Recommended**	DQL
93	Wrap multiple `summarize` aggregations in `{}`	When summarizing 2+ aggregations, wrap them: `summarize { a = count(), b = avg(x) }, by: {field}`. Unwrapped aggregations combined with `by:` raise a `PARAMETERS_SHOULD_BE_GROUPED` INFO notification; without `by:` they raise none (tenant-verified 10/14/2026). The query runs either way — wrap them for consistency.	**Recommended**	DQL

14. Where to Go Deeper — Topic Series Map

DBMON covers database monitoring foundations. These topic series cover adjacent domains in depth:

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
Distributed tracing & spans (DB spans live here)	SPANS	9
OpenPipeline log processing	OPLOGS	9
OpenPipeline beyond logs (metrics from spans)	OPIPE	7
Dynatrace Intelligence (Davis anomaly detection on DB metrics)	AIOPS	8
Workflows & alert notifications (DB alert routing)	WFLOW	12
Dashboard strategy & executive reporting	DASH	8
Bucket strategy (`default_database_monitoring` and custom DB buckets)	ORGNZ	11
IAM administration (bucket-scoped policies for DB-team access)	IAM	15

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
Tagging strategy (host-group + ownership tagging for DBs)	FAQ-01, FAQ-02	2+
Configuration automation (Monaco/Terraform for extension deployment)	AUTOM	14
OpenTelemetry integration (OTel-instrumented DBs)	OTEL	9
Cloud DB integrations (RDS, Aurora, Cosmos DB, Cloud SQL)	CLOUD	9

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